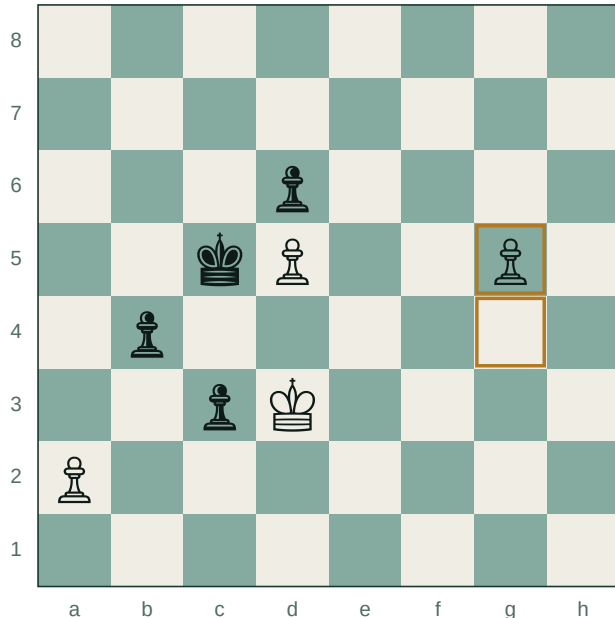


Pawn-ending calculation: Black, move 42

Pawn-ending calculation

Black to move



Previous move: 42.g5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42...Kxd5 43. g6 Ke6 44. g7 Kf7 45. a4 bxa3 46. g8=R Kxg8

42...Kxd5 The king captures the pawn on d5. Recorded reply: **43.g6**.

43...Ke6 The king moves from d5 to e6. Recorded reply: **44.g7**.

44...Kf7 The king moves from e6 to f7. Recorded reply: **45.a4**.

45...bxa3 The pawn captures the pawn on a3. Recorded reply: **46.g8=R**.

46...Kxg8 The king captures the rook on g8.

At the end, nominal material is White 0 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3**: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not enter a pawn ending because it looks simple. Rook-pawn exceptions and zugzwang can make a material advantage irrelevant.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

With only kings and pawns, a single tempo can reverse the result. Calculate opposition, capture routes, promotion races, and reserve pawn moves precisely.

HOW TO LOOK

Count actual king moves and pawn pushes, then include whose turn it is and whether promotion gives check.

The defending king is on d3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.